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Short Bio

Dr. Sun, Li is currently an Associate Professor at Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, Beijing, China. His research areas are foundation models and machine learning with special attentions to Riemannian geometry. He has published over **60** refereed top conference and journal papers, including ICML, NeurIPS, KDD, WWW, AAAI, IJCAI, WSDM, ICDM, CIKM, TOIS, TKDE, TWEB, TIST, TNSE etc., amassing over **2200** citations on Google Scholar in the past 5 years. He has routinely served as program committee member of flagship conferences and reviewer of IEEE/ACM transactions. He is the recipient of ACM CIKM 2022 best paper honorable mention. He was on the organization committee of IEEE DSS'24 and IEEE SocialCom'23. He was a guest editor for the Springer International Journal of Machine Learning and Cybernetics.

Affiliation

Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications, Beijing, China

School of Computer Science, **Associate Professor**

2025.11–Now

North China Electric Power University, Beijing, China

School of Control & Computer Engineering, **Associate Professor**

2024.1 – 2015.11

School of Control & Computer Engineering, **Assistant Professor**

2021.9 – 2023.12

Education

Visiting Scholar Univ. of Illinois at Chicago, IL, USA

2019 – 2020

Advisor: Prof. **Philip S. Yu** (ACM/IEEE Fellow)

Ph.D. Beijing Univ. of Posts & Telecommunications, China 2016 – 2021

Computer Science (Dissertation: Research on Social Network Alignment)

Advisor: Prof. **Sen Su** (The President of Chongqing Univ. of Posts and Telecomm.)

Beijing Outstanding Postgraduate Award, National Scholarship in 2019.

B.Eng. Beijing Univ. of Posts & Telecommunications, China 2012 – 2016

Internet of Things

Beijing Outstanding Graduate Award, National Scholarship in 2014 & 2015.

Professional Services

Guest Editor:

Executive Editor, **IEEE TKDE Special Issue** on *Graph Foundation Models: Database and Data Mining Perspectives* (Philip S. Yu, Li Sun, Pietro Lio, De-Nian Yang), 2026.

Lead Editor, **Springer JMLC Special Issue** on *Pertaining: Foundation, Frontiers, and Applications* (Li Sun, Hao Peng, Zhiwei Liu, Ran Wang, Lifang He, Jia Wu, Julian McAuley), 2024.

Program Committee:

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML): 2025

Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS): 2025, 2024

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR): 2026

ACM Conference on Knowledge Discovery & Data Mining (KDD): 2025, 2024, 2023

ACM Web Conference (WWW): 2026, 2025, 2024

AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI): 2026, 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022, 2021

International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI): 2025, 2024, 2022

ACM Conference on Information & Knowledge Management (CIKM): 2025, 2024

ACM Conference on Web Search & Data Mining (WSDM): 2022

SIAM International Conference on Data Mining (SDM): 2024

European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI): 2025, 2020

Journal Reviewer:

IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence

IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering

IEEE Transactions on Mobile Computing
 IEEE Transactions on Neural Network Learning System
 IEEE Transactions on Big Data
 IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence
 ACM Transactions on Knowledge Discovery from Data
 ACM Transactions on the Web
 Springer International Journal on Machine Learning and Cybernetics

Publicity Chair: IEEE DSS'24, IEEE SocialCom'23

Section Chair: WWW'25, IEEE ICDM'23, IEEE BigData'19

Honors

ACM CIKM'22, Best Paper Winners (Honorable Mention), Oct., 2022

Selected Publications

DBLP <https://dblp.org/pid/57/2405-8.html>

Google Scholar <https://scholar.google.com.hk/citations?user=df8FxPAAAAAJ>

- [1] **Li Sun**, Lanxu Yang, Jiayu Tian, et. al. *Learning to Explore: Policy-Guided Outlier Synthesis for Graph Out-of-Distribution Detection*, **AAAI'26**.
- [2] **Li Sun**, Zhenhao Huang, Ming Zhang, et. al. *Deeper with Riemannian Geometry: Overcoming Oversmoothing and Oversquashing for Graph Foundation Models*, **NeurIPS'25**.
- [3] **Li Sun**, Zhenhao Huang, Suyang Zhou, et. al. *RiemannGFM: Learning a Graph Foundation Model from Riemannian Geometry*, **WWW'25, Oral**.
- [4] **Li Sun**, Ziheng Zhang, Zixi Wang, et. al., *Pioneer: Physics-informed Riemannian Graph ODE for entropy-increasing Dynamics*, **AAAI'25, Oral**.
- [5] **Li Sun**, Suyang Zhou, Bowen Fang, et. al. *Trace: Structural Riemannian Bridge Matching for Transferable Source Localization*, **IJCAI'25**.
- [6] **Li Sun**, Zhenhao Huang, Hao Peng, et. al., *LSEnet: Lorentz Structural Entropy Neural Network for Deep Graph Clustering*, **ICML'24, Oral, Top 1%**.
- [7] **Li Sun**, Zhenhao Huang, Qiqi Wan, et. al., *Spiking Graph Neural Network on Riemannian Manifolds*, **NeurIPS'24**.
- [8] **Li Sun**, Jingbin Hu, Suyang Zhou, et. al., *RicciNet: Deep Clustering via A Riemannian Generative Model*, **WWW'24**.
- [9] **Li Sun**, Zhenhao Huang, Zixi Wang, et. al., *Motif-aware Riemannian Graph Neural Network with Generative-Contrastive Learning*, **AAAI'24, Oral**, pp. 9044-9052.
- [10] **Li Sun**, Jingbin Hu, et. al., *R-ODE: Ricci Curvature Tells When You Will Be Informed*. **SIGIR'24**.
- [11] **Li Sun**, Zhongbao Zhang, Feiyang Wang, et. al., *Aligning Dynamic Social Networks: An Optimization over Dynamic Graph Autoencoder*, **IEEE TKDE**, 2023, 35(6): 5597-5611.
- [12] **Li Sun**, Junda Ye, Hao Peng, et. al., *Self-supervised Continual Graph Learning in Adaptive Riemannian Spaces*, **AAAI'23**, pp. 4633-4642.
- [13] **Li Sun**, Feiyang Wang, Junda Ye, et. al., *CONGREGATE: Contrastive Graph Clustering in Curvature Spaces*, **IJCAI'23**, pp. 7590-7607.
- [14] **Li Sun**, Zhongbao Zhang, Junda Ye, et. al., *A Self-supervised Mixed-curvature Graph Neural Network*, **AAAI'22**, pp. 4146-4155.
- [15] **Li Sun**, Zhongbao Zhang, Jiawei Zhang, et. al., *Hyperbolic Variational Graph Neural Network for Modeling Dynamic Graphs*, **AAAI'21**, pp. 4375-4383.
- [16] **Li Sun**, Zhenhao Huang, Hua Wu, et. al., *DeepRicci: Self-supervised Graph Structure-Feature Co-Refinement for Alleviating Over-squashing*, **ICDM'23**, pp.558-567.

- [17] **Li Sun**, Junda Ye, Hao Peng, et. al., *A Self-supervised Riemannian GNN with Time Varying Curvature for Temporal Graph Learning*, **CIKM'22**, pp. 1827-1836. **Best Paper Winners** (Honorable Mention), **6/283**.
- [18] **Li Sun**, Philip S. Yu, *A Riemannian Perspective on Graph Foundation Models: Curvature as a Guiding Principle*, **Frontiers of Computer Science**, 2025
- [19] **Li Sun**, Zhongbao Zhang, Gen Li, et. al., *MC²: Unsupervised Multiple Social Network Alignment*, **ACM TIST**, 2023, 14(4): 70:1-70:22.
- [20] **Li Sun**, Yang Du, Shuai Gao, et. al., *GroupAligner: A Deep Reinforcement Learning with Domain Adaptation for Social Group Alignment*, **ACM TWEB**, 2023, 17(3): 17:1-17:30.
- [21] **Li Sun**, Zhongbao Zhang, Jiawei Zhang, et. al., *PERFECT: A Hyperbolic Embedding for Joint User and Community Alignment*, **ICDM'20**, pp. 501-510.
- [22] **Li Sun**, Junda Ye, Jiawei Zhang, Yong Yang, Mingsheng Liu, Feiyang Wang and Philip S. Yu, *Contrastive Sequential Interaction Network Learning on Co-Evolving Riemannian Spaces*, **Springer JMLC**, 2023.
- [23] Xiujin Zhang, Wenxin Jin, Haotian Hong, Pengfei Zhang, Jiting Li, Kongjing Gu, Hao Peng, **Li Sun***. *Hyperbolic Prompt Learning for Incremental Event Detection with LLMs*. **CIKM'25**.
- [24] Yujie Wang, Shuo Zhang, Junda Ye, Hao Peng, **Li Sun***. *A Mixed-Curvature Graph Diffusion Model*. **CIKM'24**.
- [25] Longzhu He, Chaozhuo Li, Peng Tang, **Li Sun***, Sen Su*, Philip S. Yu, *Devil's Hand: Data Poisoning Attacks to Locally Private Graph Learning Protocols*. **KDD'26**.
- [26] Zihao Wang, Hao Peng, Wei Dong, Yuecen Wei, **Li Sun**, Zhengtao Yu, *RPGen: Robust and Differentially Private Synthetic Image Generation*, **AAAI'26**, **Oral**.
- [27] Guangjie Zeng, Hao Peng, Angsheng Li, **Li Sun**, Chunyang Liu, Yicheng Pan, Shengze Li, Philip S. Yu, *Hyperbolic Continuous Structural Entropy for Hierarchical Clustering*, **AAAI'26**.
- [28] Zhiwei Yang, Haimei Qin, Xiaoyan Yu, Hao Peng, Lei Jiang, **Li Sun**, Zhiqin Yang, *Structural Entropy Guided Incremental Learning for Open-World Multimodal Social Event Detection*, **AAAI'26**.
- [29] Pu Li, Xiaoyan Yu, Hao Peng, Yantuan Xian, Linqin Wang, **Li Sun**, Jingyun Zhang, Philip S. Yu. *Relational Prompt-based Pre-trained Language Models for Social Event Detection*, **ACM TOIS**, 2025, 43(1):12:1-12:43.
- [30] Wei Zhang, Zhenhong Zhou, Junfeng Fang, Rongwu Xu, Yuanhe Zhang, Rui Wang, Ge Zhang, Xinfeng Li, Kun Wang, **Li Sun**, Lingjuan Lyu, Yang Liu, Sen Su. *LIFEBENCH: Evaluating Length Instruction Following in Large Language Models*, **NeurIPS'25**.
- [31] Jingyun Zhang, Hao Peng, **Li Sun**, Guanlin Wu, Chunyang Liu, Zhengtao Yu. *Unsupervised Graph Clustering with Deep Structural Entropy*, **KDD'25**.
- [32] Xiaoyan Yu, Yifan Wei, Shuaishuai Zhou, Zhiwei Yang, **Li Sun**, Hao Peng, Liehuang Zhu, Philip S. Yu. *Towards Effective, Efficient and Unsupervised Social Event Detection in the Hyperbolic Space*, **AAAI'25**, **Oral**.
- [33] Xiang Huang, Hao Peng, **Li Sun**, Hui Lin, Chunyang Liu, Jiang Cao, Philip S. Yu. *Structural Entropy Guided Probabilistic Coding*. **AAAI'25**.
- [34] Zhongbao Zhang, Shuai Gao, Sen Su, **Li Sun**, Ruiyang Chen, *MINING: Multi-Granularity Network Alignment Based on Contrastive Learning*. **IEEE TKDE**, 2023, 35(12): 12785-12798.
- [35] Zhongbao Zhang, Zichang Yin, Jian Wen, **Li Sun**, Sen Su and Philip S. Yu, *DeepBlue: Bi-layered LSTM for tweet popUlaritY Estimation*, **IEEE TKDE**, 2022, 34(10): 4737-4752.

- [36] Zhongbao Zhang, **Li Sun**, Sen Su, Jielun Qu and Gen Li, *Reconciling Multiple Social Networks Effectively and Efficiently: An Embedding Approach*, **IEEE TKDE**, 2021, 34(1): 224-238.
- [37] Zhongbao Zhang, Fuxin Ren, Jiawei Zhang, Sen Su, Yang Yan, Qian Wei, **Li Sun**, Guozhen Zhu, Congying Guo, *When Behavior Analysis Meets Social Network Alignment*, **IEEE TKDE**, 2023, 35(7): 7590-7607.
- [38] Zhiwei Yang, Haimei Qin, Hao Peng, Xiaoyan Yu, **Li Sun**, Lei Jiang, *Label-Free Contrastive Learning for Open-World Multimodal Social Event Detection*, **WSDM'25, Oral**.
- [39] Junda Ye, Zhongbao Zhang, Zhizhen He, Feiyang Wang, **Li Sun**, *Towards Multifaceted Graph Condensation in Discrete Realm*, **WSDM'25**.
- [40] Xiaoyan Yu, Jiaqian Ren, Lei Jiang, Hao Peng, Zhifeng Hao, **Li Sun**, Kun Peng, Liehuang Zhu, Philip S. Yu, *PromptSED: An evolving topic-enhanced prompting framework for incremental social event detection*, **Elsevier Neural Networks**.
- [41] Zhiwei Yang, Yuecen Wei, Haoran Li, Qian Li, Lei Jiang, **Li Sun**, Xiaoyan Yu, Chunming Hu, Hao Peng. *Adaptive Differentially Private Structural Entropy Minimization for Unsupervised Social Event Detection*. **CIKM'24**.
- [42] Kun Peng, Lei Jiang, Qian Li, Haoran Li, Xiaoyan Yu, **Li Sun**, Shuo Sun, Yanxian Bi, Hao Peng. *Table-Filling via Mean Teacher for Cross-domain Aspect Sentiment Triplet Extraction*. **CIKM'24**.
- [43] Xiaoyan Yu, Yifan Wei, Pu Li, Shuaishuai Zhou, Hao Peng, **Li Sun**, Liehuang Zhu and Philip S. Yu. *DAME: Personalized Federated Social Event Detection with Dual Aggregation Mechanism*. **CIKM'24**.
- [44] Zhe Liu, Xiang Huang, Jingyun Zhang, **Li Sun**, Zhifeng Hao and Hao Peng. *Multivariate Time-Series Anomaly Detection based on Enhancing Graph Attention Networks with Topological Analysis*. **CIKM'24**.
- [45] Junda Ye, Zhongbao Zhang, **Li Sun**, Yang Yan, Feiyang Wang and Fuxin Ren, *SINCERE: Sequential Interaction Networks representation learning on Co-Evolving Riemannian manifolds*, **WWW'23 (Oral)**, pp. 360-371.
- [46] Feiyang Wang, Zhongbao Zhang, **Li Sun**, Junda Ye and Yang Yan, *DiriE: Knowledge Graph Embedding with Dirichlet Distribution*, **WWW'22**, pp. 3082-3091.
- [47] Xiao Li, **Li Sun**, Mengjie Ling, Yan Peng, *A Survey of Graph Neural Network based Recommendation in Social Networks*, **Neurocomputing**, 2023, 547: 126441.
- [48] Huafeng Cao, Zhongbao Zhang, **Li Sun** and Zhi Wang, *Inductive and irregular dynamic network representation based on ordinary differential equations*, **KBS**, 2021, 227: 107271.
- [49] Siyuan Gao, Zhongbao Zhang, Sen Su, Jian Wen and **Li Sun**, *Fair-Aware Competitive Event Influence Maximization in Social Networks*, **IEEE Trans. on Netw. Sci. Eng.**, 2020, 7(4): 2528-2540.
- [50] Yingtong Dou, Zhiwei Liu, **Li Sun**, Yutong Deng, Hao Peng and Philip S. Yu, *Enhancing Graph Neural Network-based Fraud Detectors against Camouflaged Fraudsters*, **CIKM'20**, pp. 315-324.
- [51] Fuxin Ren, Zhongbao Zhang, Jiawei Zhang, Sen Su, **Li Sun**, Guozhen Zhu and Congying Guo, *BANANA: when Behavior ANALysis meets social Network Alignment*, **IJCAI'20**, pp. 1438-1444.
- [52] Sen Su, **Li Sun**, Zhongbao Zhang, Gen Li and Jielun Qu, *MASTER: across Multiple social networks, integrate Attribute and STructure Embedding for Reconciliation*, **IJCAI'18**, pp. 3863-3869.
- [53] Zhongbao Zhang, Jian Wen, **Li Sun**, Qiaoyu Deng, Sen Su and Pengyan Yao, *Efficient incremental dynamic link prediction algorithms in social network*, **KBS**, 2017, 132:226-235.

Reference

Available upon request.